Year/ Semester	**:**	**III-year B.Tech. I Semester**
Branch	**:**	**All Branches**
Academic Year	**:**	**2025–'26**
Subject	**:**	**Professional Ethics and Human Values**
Subject Code	**:**	**22OE1HS301**

Key Prepared by

Dr. Chakravarthula Kiran

(12EIE069)

Associate Professor, Dept. of EIE

Scheme of Evaluation

- This is a theory course but that does not mean that full credit cannot be given to students. The sincerity ("conscientiousness", as defined as "the intention to do the right thing") of the students that reflects in the answers, together with suitable presentation of concepts with more emphasis on their understanding than on theory, may be evaluated really, and **full credit may be given** where deemed fit.
- This course is primarily taught with more emphasis on application of ethics and understanding of morals in the context of personal and professional lives, modulated to the level of comprehension of undergraduate students. **The evaluation may thus consider not mere regurgitation of theory learnt from books but the practical implications of the answers written by students.** Students' **answers thus reflect their own understanding** and may not partially or fully match any specific textbook content or any other standard sources of content. **Discretion and case-by-case evaluation is thus most suited for evaluation.**
- Students are **expected to present insights based on the information provided and based on concepts learnt in the course**. Thus, **simplistic statements and general commentary may not be considered sufficient for any answer**; students **must articulate their learning** through relevant keywords, concepts, theories, and logical bases as may be indicated by the corresponding Revised Bloom's Taxonomy level for each question.
- There are no fixed answers or fixed justifications/reasoning to any argument or case. Students may present their views on either side of an argument and may use one or more theories and concepts to justify their stance. It may even be possible that they present the arguments on both sides and/or present different ways of applying same concepts and theories. In any case, the evaluators may see the answers objectively and avoid all personal biases in judging the "rightness" of the answer. That is to say that ***answers may not seem* right *but may still be* correct**!
- Students may use one or more real or hypothetical examples (or counterarguments) to make their point clearer. Examples are only deemed necessary when the question specifies so but can be an added value even otherwise. Thus, an ill-defined but well-illustrated concept/ theory deserves the same or better credit as a well-defined concept that is not illustrated with suitable examples.
- **The length of the answer does not define the correctness or rightness of the answer.** What is really important is an understanding of relevant concepts and presentation of ideas and "connecting the dots". It is not sometimes surprising if a 10-mark question has an answer that is less than 1-page long, if the answer itself is self-explanatory and "feels" complete. It may be noted that answers by some students may be more elaborate or comprehensive than some others.
- Credit shall be suitably divided between (i) definitions of keywords used in the question/ answer, (ii) concept/ theory/ principle pertaining to morals/ ethics/ values, (iii) examples used to elaborate/ demonstrate the presented ideas, (iv) creative ways (including creativity in choosing the examples) of presenting the answer.
- Care may be taken to ensure that one student's answers do not influence another student's evaluation, and that the evaluation of one answer must not influence the evaluation of another answer by the same student.

Disclosure/ Disclaimer

This key is provided only to provide a generic/common approach to the questions posed in the examination. Thus, this key may not be treated as a comprehensive and all-inclusive guide for the answers. Owing to the generic nature of the subject and the questions, students may employ different approaches, presentation styles, or levels of elaboration. **It is requested that the evaluator shall be accommodating towards all the diverse approaches that may seem valid at the outset, giving the benefit of doubt to the examinees/ students accordingly.** Practical knowledge and applicability of various theories and concepts learnt in the subject may vary from student to student and **can only be assessed when the evaluator puts one's own experience into understanding the presented answers**.

Part-A

a) Morals are always positive, and values may be positive or negative. A moral may be defined as something pertaining to a custom or usage, a principle or habit with respect to right or wrong conduct, or something concerned with the principles of right conduct and distinction between right and wrong. A value may be defined as a relative worth or importance, or something that is held to deserve, or an assigned/estimated worth, or a desirable quality. (Any one of the definitions listed above, for each, may be considered complete.)

b) Deontological ethics is also called Duty Ethics. It is a moral theory that judges the rightness or wrongness of actions based on rules, duties, or principles, rather than their consequences. It emphasises that certain actions are inherently right or wrong, regardless of the outcomes they produce. Performing one's duty is considered ethical, or an action is morally right if it follows a moral rule or duty (even if the outcome is bad).

c) Informed consent refers to a person voluntarily agreeing after being fully informed about the nature, risks, benefits, and alternatives in a particular context/ aspect/ topic/ situation.

d) Intellectual Property (IP) refers to creation of the mind inventions, literary and artistic works, designs, symbols, names, and images that are legally protected through patents, copyrights, trademarks, and trade secrets. Anything created out of an individual's or a group's intellect may be considered IP.

e) Occupational crime is a crime committed by individuals through misuse of professional position, trust, or authority. It usually involves breach of trust/ confidentiality or abuse of responsibility.

PART-B

1) a) Trolley problem refers to moral decision-making in situations where harm cannot be avoided, and a choice must be made between competing moral principles. It is a good way to analyse the differences between deontological and consequential ethics. The Trolley Problem illustrates that moral decisions are not based only on outcomes but also on intentions, duties, and moral rules. It is widely applied in fields such as engineering ethics, medical ethics, law, and artificial intelligence to understand ethical responsibility in critical decision-making.

The trolley problem is defined where there is a train/ trolley coming on one set of tracks and there are people on that track as well as an alternate track. The problem requires the respondent to imagine oneself as a person who has the access to pull a lever to divert the trolley from one track to another. Different cases of the problem typically involve different sets of people on different tracks, though there are cases like "Footbridge and Fat Man" which are not generally presented.

- Case 1: Track 1 has five persons tied on the track, Track 2 has one person tied on the track. If the lever is pulled one person will die, but if it is not pulled five will die.
- Case 2: Track 1 has five kids playing on it, and Track 2 has been long-unused and has one kid playing on it. In this case, pulling the lever can kill a kid who is on a track that is not expected to be used by a trolley while the five kids are playing on a live track, and they know they may be run down and are thus more alert than the kid on Track 2.
- Case 3: Track 1 has young people, Track 2 has old people.
- Case 4: Track 1 has scientists, Track 2 has unintelligent people.
- Case 5: Track 1 has a pregnant lady, Track 2 has an adult and a kid or two adults.

There can be many more variants, including individuals of different races and regions. In all these cases, one is a lesser evil than the other, and how one decides that depends on ethical and moral issues. It involves assessment of total harm and saving some human lives while killing some others. Each case highlights the importance of intention, physical involvement, and respect for individual rights in moral judgement. Deontological ethics may justify pulling the lever if it's one's moral duty or job responsibility, while utilitarianism justifies an action as ethical if it's for the greater good and kills lesser number of people.

Each case may be considered for 2 marks each, and the basic understanding of the keywords (trolley problem, ethical and moral issues) may be considered for 2 marks each.

b) **Value Judgement:** A value judgement refers to an assessment of what is important, desirable, or worthwhile based on personal, social, cultural, or professional values. It helps in prioritising goals such as safety, profit, efficiency, equality, or public welfare. Value judgement is based on what must be considered important. In decision-making, value judgements guide the selection of alternatives. For example, choosing public safety over cost reduction in an engineering project reflects a value judgement.

Moral Judgement: A moral judgement is an evaluation of whether an action is right or wrong, ethical or unethical, based on moral principles, ethical theories, and professional codes of conduct. It is based on what must be done. Moral judgement ensures that decisions respect ethical standards, human rights, honesty, and responsibility. For example, refusing to approve a faulty design even under pressure requires strong moral judgement.

Typically, moral judgement takes longer to make and needs more comprehensive information whereas value judgement relies on the available information and can thus be narrow in scope of consideration. Most quick decisions thus may be seen as value judgements; ideally, if one's values are always morally high, a value judgement can be closer to and/or aligns with the moral judgement.

Effective decision-making requires both value judgement and moral judgement. Value judgement helps in identifying priorities and alternatives, while moral judgement ensures that the final decision is ethically acceptable. Without value judgement, decisions lack direction; without moral judgement, decisions may become unethical and harmful. Together, they promote responsible, just, and ethical decision-making in personal and professional life.

Each definition may be considered for 1.5 marks each, and their importance may be given 1 mark. Some students may present the importance implicitly and not be exclusive of the definition. 2 marks each may be considered in that case.

2) a) Ethics, values, and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) are closely interconnected and together guide responsible decision-making for the welfare of present and future generations.

Values indicate relative worth and fundamental beliefs of what is important and desirable. Ethics indicate a moral philosophy, application of values, and the science of conduct, and thus translate values into rules, standards, and actions, especially in professional and societal contexts. 17 SDG have been named by the United Nations to promote balanced development in economic growth, social inclusion, and environmental protection. These goals are inherently driven by values and ethics and ensure fairness and justice for all humanity.

Values provide the moral foundation, ethics provides the decision-making framework, and SDG provide the global action plan. Ethical behaviour guided by strong human values is essential to achieve sustainable development. Sustainability is also important in the context of equity, justice, and fair use/ distribution/ access to natural resources and essential services in various walks of life such health, livelihoods and employment, and education.

Each example may carry 2 mark each if presented along with the relationship or separately, with the maximum of 5 marks being given even if explanation is presented only with examples. If no examples are given but the relationship is explained, 3 marks may be given out of 5. Students may choose to give examples of different SDG and explain, but specific definitions of SDG are not necessary as long as they present the idea of the SDG.

b) It is important for engineering students to learn human values before professional ethics because human values form the moral character and inner conscience of an individual, while professional ethics provides external rules and codes of conduct. Ethics are developed through application of values, and thus also values precede ethics. **Human values** such as honesty, empathy, respect for life, responsibility, and integrity help students develop a **strong moral foundation**. These values shape attitudes and intentions, enabling individuals to naturally distinguish between right and wrong. **Without internal values, professional ethics may be followed only out of fear of punishment rather than genuine moral commitment.** Engineering decisions often have a direct impact on public safety, environment, and society. If students lack human values, they may misuse technical knowledge for personal gain, leading to unethical practices such as corruption, negligence, or unsafe designs. **Learning human values first ensures that professional ethics is practiced with sincerity and social concern.** Moreover, **human values encourage engineers** to think beyond profit and efficiency and **consider social welfare and sustainability**, which is essential in modern engineering practice aligned with sustainable development goals.

The answer must convey the importance of human values and of professional ethics and the justification of why human values form a basis for learning professional ethics. Examples of human values and of professional ethics may carry 0.5–1 mark each. The motivation for values and ethics may carry 1 mark. The foundational basis of values for ethics, even without examples, carries 2–3 marks.

3) a) Kohlberg's theory of moral development outlines three levels and six stages.

- **Level 1: Pre-conventional** - Common in children; moral reasoning is based on external consequences
  - Stage 1: Obedience and Punishment Orientation
    - At this stage, actions are judged as right or wrong based on punishment. An individual obeys rules to avoid punishment.
    - Example: A child does not steal because he is afraid of being punished.
  - Stage 2: Individualism and Exchange Orientation
    - Moral decisions are based on self-interest and personal benefit.
    - Example: A student helps a friend only because he expects help in return.
- **Level 2: Conventional** – Individuals conform to social rules and expectations
  - Stage 3: Good Interpersonal Relationships (Good Boy/ Good Girl)
    - Moral behaviour is driven by the desire to gain approval from others.
    - Example: A person follows rules to be seen as a "good citizen".
  - Stage 4: Law and Order Orientation
    - Right action is defined by obeying laws and maintaining social order.
    - Example: An engineer follows safety regulations because laws must be obeyed.
- **Level 3: Post-conventional** - reflects abstract reasoning and understanding ethical principles
  - Stage 5: Social Contract Orientation
    - Laws are seen as social agreements to promote the greatest good.
    - Example: Supporting changes in unfair laws through legal means.
  - Stage 6: Universal Ethical Principles
    - Moral reasoning is based on universal principles such as justice and human rights, even if laws conflict.
    - Example: A person refuses to follow an unjust law that violates human dignity.

The three levels and when they are seen or how they are developed carries 1.5 marks. The 6 stages may not be explicitly named but the stages and examples may be distributed the remaining weightage equally. (Kohlberg's theory talks about "Level 4+" which is kind of bonus content. Mentioning that could be considered for bonus credit if max. marks are not already attained.)

b) Aristotle proposed Virtue Ethics, which **focuses on moral character rather than rules or consequences**. In other words, ethics is about first becoming a good person by cultivating virtues, so that actions are ethical by virtue.

- Virtues are defined as **good character traits** such as honesty, courage, generosity, and temperance. Practising these virtues makes an individual a **"virtuous agent**" or someone of moral excellence.
- Virtue lies between the **two extremes of excess and deficiency**.
- Virtues are not inborn and must be cultivated through habit and must be practised rigorously. A person becomes virtuous agent only by performing virtuous actions regularly.
- Virtues are developed by being rational and when moral decisions are guided by reason, thereby helping understand the right action in each situation.
- Virtuous living **can lead to happiness** (*eudaimonia*), and that is the goal of life.

The text in bold may be considered key concepts for 1 mark each. Mentioning the focus on moral character instead of conduct may be given 2 marks as that is the fundamental difference.

4) Maslow's hierarchy of human needs assumes that humans are motivated by the same sequence of needs regardless of gender. Lawrence Kohlberg and Carol Gilligan later developed moral development theories that distinguish motivations between male and female genders respectively.

- **Argument 1: Maslow's Pyramid applies to both men and women**
  - Fundamental human needs such as physiological survival, safety, belongingness, esteem, and self-actualisation arise from biological and psychological necessities, which are common to all human beings regardless of gender. Hunger, safety, social connection, self-respect, and personal growth are essential for everyone, making the foundation of Maslow's pyramid universally applicable.
  - Ethical principles such as equality and non-discrimination are also regardless of gender.
  - Single pyramid for all genders promotes inclusiveness.
  - Maslow's theory proposes that such and such needs *exist* and not about the how they are addressed. How men and women may satisfy their respective needs does not change that they have the same needs.
- **Argument 2: Maslow's Pyramid must be separate for men and women**
  - Kohlberg proposed the moral development theory and Gilligan who worked with him on the same noticed that women are excluded from the experimentation and thus studied the same in women and proposed Ethics of Care, stating that moral reasoning is grounded in relationships, empathy, interdependence, and context-based reasoning unlike Kohlberg's emphasis on rules and rights.
  - Thus, it may be argued that the Maslow's Pyramid may justify unified model in the first two basic classes of needs (Physiological and Security) or may be even Social needs but the motivation further up is different for males and females.
  - Esteem and Self-actualisation do not necessarily mean the same things and do not stem out of the same sources for men and women, since the fundamental bases for the feeling of recognition is individualistic among men and based on relationships among women, for instance.
  - Context becomes important for moral decision-making according to Gilligan's theory, and thus the needs incorporate context and morality sooner. Morality also becomes a part of women's mindsets much earlier than men's, according to Gilligan, and that necessitates a different perspective at needs in both genders.

Students may take either stand. The justification of their stand is what is really more important than the stand itself. The basic justification may be considered for 2 marks. A basic outline/ explanation of any of the three theories may be considered for 1–3 marks each based on the elaboration. The need for a separate pyramid or the lack thereof may be considered for 3–5 marks.

5) a) A STEM professional working as a manager or leader holds ethical responsibilities not only toward the organisation but also toward employees, society, and the environment. Ethical leadership ensures responsible use of scientific and technical knowledge as well as fairness and non-discrimination. Accountability and responsibility are also central to ethical leadership and management. Ethical leaders set an example for ethical behaviour within the organisation.

A STEM leader has the **responsibility to ensure public safety and welfare**. Decisions related to design, production, data usage, or technology deployment must prioritise human life and safety over profit or deadlines. Negligence or compromise in safety can lead to serious harm. Moral responsibility of praiseworthiness/ blameworthiness, job responsibility of doing something in the right manner, causal responsibility of being accountable not just for the outcome but also for the actions are a part of leadership traits.

A STEM manager must practice honesty and integrity in professional conduct. This includes truthful reporting of data, avoiding fabrication or falsification of results, and transparent communication with stakeholders. STEM managers are also expected to make ethical decisions, be compliant to all relevant laws, and be mindful of business ethics, which include responsibility towards sustainability and environment, quality of work life, and diverse consequences of business activities.

The question is a little vague by using “or” instead of “and”. Marks may be justified accordingly if only engineer as a manager OR as a leader is mentioned, if there is enough elaboration. The text in bold is the key consideration for any STEM professional in any role and carries 1 mark. 1 mark each may be considered for the roles of manager and leader (or 2 marks for either if there is enough elaboration, in case only one of them is mentioned). Examples may be given due credit in either case, with at least 1 mark per example. Any responsibilities or use cases for manager/ leader may be given 0.5–1 mark each.

b) DEIA stands for Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Accessibility. In STEM professions, DEIA is essential for ethical and effective professional practice. Diversity brings people from different backgrounds, genders, and cultures, leading to broader perspectives and innovative solutions. Equity ensures fair access to opportunities and resources, correcting historical disadvantages. Inclusion creates a respectful work environment where everyone feels valued and heard. Accessibility ensures that people with disabilities or different abilities can also fully participate in STEM education and workplaces without feeling devalued or underprivileged. DEIA promotes ethical fairness, social justice, and innovation, making STEM professions more representative and socially responsible.

Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), introduced by the United Nations, provide a global framework for sustainable and ethical development. STEM professionals play a critical role in achieving SDGs such as quality education, clean energy, clean water, industry innovation, climate action, and sustainable cities. Ethical application of science and technology is essential to address global challenges like climate change, poverty, and resource depletion. STEM professions strive to make lives, livelihoods, and lifestyles better, through appropriate applications of science, technology, and engineering. The appropriateness of such applications must also keep sustainable development as well as DEIA in mind.

Definitions of DEIA carry 2 marks and definition of SDG carries 1 mark. Their importance in STEM professional roles carries 2 marks. The focus therein must be on justice, fairness/ equity/ equality, sustainability, and how STEM professionals must care about greater good.

6) Engineering as a profession is social experimentation since engineering activity has its ultimate effect on society and humanity, making the society, environment, human being, and other lifeforms "subjects" of the experiments. Innovation may be seen as a social need thus, since the fruits of innovation can help the society take a developmental leap that is not otherwise possible.

   Citizen Science, as defined in the question, refers to "active participation of public in scientific research projects", which implicitly includes social experimentation. Melanie Smallman's book proposes that Responsible Research and Innovation (RRI) can be used as an approach to tackle social challenges by connecting science and society. Since Citizen Science is about the involvement of society in the advancement of science, RRI can be a good approach to employ for ethical and responsible collection of information from individuals and society at large.

   Engineers play various roles in their profession, including that of a saviour (one who saves after a harm occurs) or a guardian (one who protects to prevent harm from occurring). It is thus the responsibility of an engineer to ensure that the planning, design, and implementation of scientific research does not affect the rights and wellbeing of general public and that utilitarian approach is taken for scientific advancement, with due regard to environment and other voiceless "subjects" of the experiment.

   Engineers must also, in this context, ensure that certain marginalised communities or individuals are not ignored in accessing the benefits of scientific advancement. It is important to design and conduct scientific research with an inclusive approach thus ensuring target user groups are not ignored in understanding the social impact of scientific research.

Students may touch upon professional roles and responsibilities, informed consent, rights of subjects, innovation, social experimentation, and similar aspects in answering the question. The emphasis of any of these aspects or other aspects that they may mention may be evaluated duly, for what it's worth. Each concept and explanation/ example may be seen to carry 2–4 marks. Specifically, professional roles and need for innovation and its social context may carry 2 marks each.

7) The Titanic disaster of 1912 is a classic case used in ethics to analyse deviations from ethical principles in engineering, management, and decision-making. Applying ethical principles helps identify where moral and professional responsibilities were violated.
   - The Titanic carried insufficient lifeboats, despite knowing the ship could carry more than 2,200 passengers. This violated the duty to protect human life and directly contributed to massive loss of life. (It may be noted that the regulations in 1912 did not also allow them to carry enough lifeboats!)
   - The ship was operated at high speed in iceberg-prone waters, ignoring multiple iceberg warnings. This shows negligence and failure to act responsibly under known risks. (Radio messages were ignored by the operators.)
   - The Titanic was promoted as "The Unsinkable Ship", creating false confidence among passengers and crew. This misrepresentation reduced preparedness and violated ethical honesty and also did not communicate risk transparently to the stakeholders.
   - As Titanic was essentially promoted as a luxury ship, luxury and cosmetics took higher priority than safety considerations, and thus design and safety decisions were influenced by commercial competition and unethical compromises. (There was no binoculars in the crow's nest!)

- Lifeboat access favoured first-class passengers, while third-class passengers were disadvantaged, violating the principle of justice and fairness/ equality.
- The tests were also shortened and hastened due to competition and pressure of launch despite previous accidents of the White Starliner company that made the Titanic, in order to save their business reputation.

Since the question is for 7 marks and not 10 marks like in the previous question papers, an all-inclusive answer is not needed. Depending on the specifics, each aspect of deviance and/or ethical principle may be seen to carry 1–2 marks. Thus, the answer may just "list" up to 7 such deviances + principles or may elaborate up to 3 such deviances + principles for full credit.

b) A Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) is a legal and ethical contract that prevents individuals from sharing confidential or sensitive information obtained during professional work. NDA protect confidential information, such as trade secrets, research data, client details, and intellectual property. Maintaining confidentiality is a core ethical duty of professionals. NDAs help build trust between organizations, professionals, and clients. Ethical professionalism depends on the assurance that sensitive information will not be misused. NDAs prevent conflicts of interest and misuse of privileged information, ensuring fairness and integrity in professional practice.

Basic definition and what it protects carries 2 marks. Why such protection is important carries 1–2 marks. Use cases and examples carry 1–2 marks.

8) a) Environmental ethics is a branch of applied ethics that deals with the moral relationship between human beings and the natural environment. It emphasises the responsibility of individuals, organizations, and industries to protect nature and ensure sustainable use of natural resources. Industries have a major ethical responsibility because industrial activities are among the largest contributors to carbon emissions, pollution, and climate change. Carbon footprint refers to the total amount of greenhouse gases, especially carbon dioxide, released directly or indirectly by industrial processes. Reducing carbon footprint is essential to protect environmental sustainability, to prevent harm to future generations, to maintain ecological balance, and to fulfil social responsibility towards society. Industries can reduce carbon footprint by adopting renewable energy, energy-efficient technologies, waste reduction, recycling, and green manufacturing practices. From an ethical perspective, prioritising profit over environmental safety violates the principle of non-maleficence (do no harm).

Basic definitions of environmental ethics and carbon footprint carry 2 marks. Why environmental ethics are important carries 1–2 marks and the need to reduce carbon footprint carries 1–2 marks. Students may mention how the carbon footprint increases, which may be considered as complementary to the importance of environmental ethics.

b) Digital ethics refers to the moral principles that guide the development and use of digital technologies such as Artificial Intelligence (AI), Machine Learning (ML), Cloud Computing, *etc*. In today's digital world, technology directly affects privacy, decision-making, equality, and human rights.

- **Data Privacy and Confidentiality**
  - AI and cloud platforms handle massive amounts of personal data. Ethical use requires protecting user privacy and preventing unauthorized data access.
  - Example: Misuse of personal data by social media or cloud service providers violates ethical privacy principles.
- **Bias and Fairness in AI Systems**
  - ML systems learn from data that may contain social bias. Ethical responsibility requires ensuring fair, unbiased, and transparent algorithms.

  - Example: AI-based recruitment systems rejecting candidates due to gender or caste bias.
- **Transparency and Accountability**
  - Ethical digital systems must be "explainable", and responsibility must be clearly defined when systems fail.
  - Example: Who is responsible if an AI-based medical diagnosis system gives a wrong result?
- **Security and Trust in Cloud Computing**
  - Cloud computing stores sensitive business and personal information. Ethical practice requires strong cybersecurity measures to prevent data breaches.
- **Social Impact and Human Control**
  - Digital ethics ensures that AI supports human decision-making rather than replacing human judgment in critical areas.
  - Example: Ethical concerns in using AI for mass surveillance or autonomous weapons.

Students may not present so many aspects/ examples and may discuss some other aspects of technologies and their applications. The examiner may use the allotted weightage to make a justified evaluation. One or two of the above with suitable examples can qualify for full credit. A list of various use cases where digital ethics are important may be considered as examples and qualifies for partial credit (2–3 marks) and so does a list of issues where digital ethics come into play.

9) a) Workplace deviance refers to voluntary behaviour by employees that violates organisational norms, rules, or ethical standards, and threatens the well-being of the organisation or its members. Such behaviour has serious negative effects on the organisational climate, which reflects the shared perceptions of employees about the work environment. Such deviances reduce trust and mutual respect among employees. Dishonesty, harassment, or misuse of resources create suspicion, weakening teamwork and collaboration.

Deviant behaviour negatively impacts employee morale and motivation. When unethical actions go unpunished, ethical employees feel demotivated, leading to frustration and disengagement. Consequently, a toxic culture characterised by fear, conflict, and stress prevails at the workplace, leading to frequent absenteeism, reduction of turnover, and mental health issues among employees. Organisational performance and productivity is affected as time and resources get wasted on conflict management, disciplinary actions, and damage control instead of productive work. Eventually, the organisation's reputation is affected and can result in loss of stakeholder trust and long-term sustainability.

Workplace deviances can thus have impacts whether they are **minor, interpersonal, or serious, organisational**. Ignoring such deviances does not remove the consequences and can be more problematic.

Definition of workplace deviance carries 1 mark and examples carry 0.5–1 mark each based on elaboration. How they can impact at interpersonal level and at organisational level carries 2 marks each if examples are cited or 1 mark each if no examples are mentioned. The classification of workplace deviance (in bold above), if mentioned, may be considered for 1 mark. Examiner discretion is expected.

b) Religion and spirituality play a significant role in shaping societal moral standards by providing ethical guidelines, moral values, and a sense of purpose. Religion establishes moral codes through scriptures, traditions, and teachings that define right and wrong behaviour. Principles such as

honesty, compassion, justice, non-violence, and respect for life are commonly promoted across religions. These moral teachings influence laws, social norms, and cultural practices.

Spirituality emphasises inner conscience, self-awareness, and moral responsibility and encourages individuals to act ethically out of personal conviction rather than fear of punishment.

Religion and spirituality also promote social cohesion and ethical discipline by encouraging moral behaviour through community practices and shared beliefs.

Concepts like *karma*, *ahimsa*, or the Golden Rule guide moral behaviour in societies by emphasising responsibility and empathy. The Golden Rule is a part of all major religions of the world, in some or the other form.

Religion and spirituality can influence the moral development, but moral development is proven to happen as a part of evolution and not only through religious or spiritual practices.

Basic definitions of religion, spirituality, morality (and/or civic virtue) together carry 2 marks. How religion and/or spirituality develop morality carries 2 marks and any examples qualify for full credit. Some students may argue that religion and/or spirituality are not needed for shaping morality, which is also discussed in the classroom through relevant a TED talk. Thus, if that argument is presented solidly, examiner may consider such an argument also for full credit, without inherent bias or because it defies the question.

10) Betting apps and real-money gaming platforms such as 1XBET, despite legal restrictions, continue to promote gambling through aggressive digital advertising. These advertisements often target vulnerable groups—middle-class families, elderly individuals, illiterate audiences, and financially stressed students—by projecting unrealistic success stories and instant wealth. This situation raises serious ethical concerns that extend far beyond business ethics and enter multiple other ethical domains.

- **Social Ethics:**
  - Social ethics concerns the moral responsibility of organisations toward society and social well-being. Betting platforms exploit economically vulnerable populations by encouraging risky behaviour that can lead to financial ruin, addiction, family conflict, and social instability.
  - Targeting middle-class and elderly individuals with promises of easy money violates social responsibility, as it preys on hope, insecurity, and lack of financial literacy. Such practices weaken social trust and contribute to long-term social harm.
- **Media/ Advertising/ Business Ethics:**
  - Media ethics demands honesty, fairness, and social responsibility in advertising. Betting app advertisements often portray misleading success stories, hide risks and losses, or use emotional manipulation and celebrity influence.
  - These practices violate ethical principles of truthfulness, transparency, and informed choice. Advertising gambling as a guaranteed income source is ethically deceptive and socially irresponsible.
- **Educational Ethics:**
  - Educational ethics emphasises the moral responsibility to protect learners and promote constructive development. The involvement of B.Tech. and other students in betting due to financial pressure undermines academic focus, mental well-being, and professional integrity.
  - Instead of skill development and learning, students are drawn toward short-term gambling behaviour, contradicting the ethical purpose of education as empowerment and self-reliance.

- Eventually, students may get into more unlawful and unethical activities and practices in order to get out of their financial losses.

- **Digital Ethics:**
  - Digital ethics relates to responsible use of digital platforms and data. Betting apps misuse social media algorithms to target users based on age, financial stress, and browsing behaviour. This raises concerns related to exploitation through targeted manipulation, absence of consent awareness, and encouragement of addictive behaviour.
  - Such algorithmic targeting violates ethical principles of fairness, autonomy, and digital responsibility.
- **Psychological and Professional Ethics:**
  - Psychological ethics requires avoiding practices that can cause addiction, emotional distress, and dependency. Betting apps deliberately design reward mechanisms that encourage compulsive behaviour. Professionals involved in designing such systems violate ethical responsibility toward human well-being.

Eradication of such unethical practices requires strong regulatory and legal enforcement and frequent audits/ checks of the same. Social media companies and advertising agencies/ ad management platforms must be held accountable if they host such ads too. Public awareness must be improved through systematic education and financial literacy must be promoted as fundamental knowledge for life, with particular focus on vulnerable communities and potential target groups. Educational institutions must play their role through systematic education towards ethics, financial responsibility, and digital wellbeing. Businesses and digital platforms must adopt ethical algorithm design for user protection and transparency.

Each category of ethics—business ethics, social ethics, media ethics, educational ethics—may be considered for 2 marks each. Strategy to eradicate such practices may carry 2–4marks, based on the elaboration and if not all categories above are explicitly discussed. (The question mentions these categories of applied ethics only as examples and not necessarily as mandatory elaborations required for full credit. Thus, if only one or two of these are explained, it may still be considered for full credit depending on elaboration/ examples. Since these are applied ethics, the knowledge of such application must be evaluated more than the theoretical elaboration. Some students may present their answers with inherent emotionality if they know people, including themselves, who are affected by these apps. Such emotionality may be considered for credit if the sincerity in the strategy part of the answer reflects their urge to help such people.

*****End of Key*****